

MAHA METRO: THE SMARTER SOLUTION FOR URBAN CONNECTIVITY

Hingna Depot, Nagpur

OVER the last decade or so, Indian infrastructure sector has witnessed huge investment. The quantum of investments has matched gigantic levels with which projects are being executed. Projects involving construction of roads, bridges, fly-overs, expansion of existing railway network are some developmental ventures visible across length and breadth of the country.

Along with road and rail transport, Metro Rail Sector – despite being a capital-intensive sector, has commanded high priority rating and has witnessed transformative growth over the past decade and is now evolving under the influence of several structural and policy trends. The number of Tier–I & Tier–II cities executing Metro rail Projects is increasing.

With Metro Rail Sector commanding priority, Maharashtra Metro Rail Corporation Limited or Maha Metro was tasked with creating network across state, except Mumbai Metropolitan Region. Presently, Maha Metro is executing projects at Nagpur, Pune and has initiated work at Thane. Maha Metro is 50:50 joint venture of GoI & GoM.

NAGPUR: Known as Orange City, Nagpur is also Gateway to Tiger corridor. Considering its geographical location and its identity as fast-growing Tier–II city, Nagpur Metro work started work on Phase–I in 2015 and hasn't just completed it, but executing it successfully. Phase–II construction work has already started and project is scheduled for completion in 3 years.

Following are key takeaways of Nagpur Metro Rail Project Phase–I & II:

Phase–I (Completed):

- Project Completion Date – 11th December 2022
- Completion Cost - ₹ 9759.60 crore
- Length – 40.02km
- Stations – 38
- Current Ridership – 1.05 lakh

Phase–II (Under Construction):

- Project Completion Date – 31st March 2029
- Completion Cost - ₹ 6708 crores
- Length – 43.8km
- Stations – 32



Shivaji Nagar Metro Station (Pune)



Tanpura footway bridge with Chhtrapati Sambhaji Maharaj Uddyan Metro Station (Pune)

PUNE: Cultural capital of Maharashtra, and Tier-1 city with a mix of traditional heritage and modern development, Pune is also a major educational center and is also the automobile and manufacturing and IT sector hub. A sprawling city and proximity to state capital of Mumbai, adds to overall importance of Pune.

\Phase–I (Completed):

- Project Completion Date – September 2024
- Completion Cost - ₹ 13656.22 crore
- Length – 33.28km
- Stations – 30
- Current Ridership – 2.25 lakh

Phase–I Extension (PCMC – Nigdi) (Under Construction):

- Project Completion Date – 31st January 2027
- Completion Cost - ₹ 910.18 crores
- Length – 4.413km
- Stations – 4
- Physical Progress – 28.68%
- Financial Progress – 18.38%

Phase–I Extension (Swargate – Katraj) (Under Constuction):

- Project Completion Date – 31st March 2029
- Completion Cost - ₹ 2954.53 crores
- Length – 5.464km
- Stations - 5

Phase –II (Corridor 2A: Vanaz to Chandani Chowk & Corridor 2B: Ramwadi to Wagholi/ Vitthalwadi)

- Sanction Date – 16th July 2025
- Project Completion Date – 31st July 2029
- Completion Cost - ₹ 3626.24 crores
- Length – 12.75km
- Stations - 13

Phase–II {Kharadi-Khadakwasla (Line-4) and Nal Stop-Warje- Manik Baug (Line-4A)} (Proposed)

- Sanction Date – 26th November 2025
- Project Completion Date – 31st December 2030
- Completion Cost - ₹ 9857.85crores
- Length – 31.636km
- Stations – 28.

THANE: Metro Rail Project here was conceived considering ever-increasing population – as per 2011 census Thane is 16th most populated city in the country with a population of 18.9 Lakhs. Thane is an immediate neighbor of Mumbai and its projected population for 2025, 2035 and 2045 is expected to be 27.34 lakhs, 34.99 lakh and 39.45 lakh respectively. Thane Integral Ring Metro Rail Project spans over distance of 29 km and is circuitous in nature.

Salient features of the project:

- Project Start Date – 5th October 2024
- Project Completion Date – 30th September 2029
- Completion Cost - ₹ 12200.10 crores
- Length – 29km
- Stations – 22